

Partisan Migration and Political Segregation

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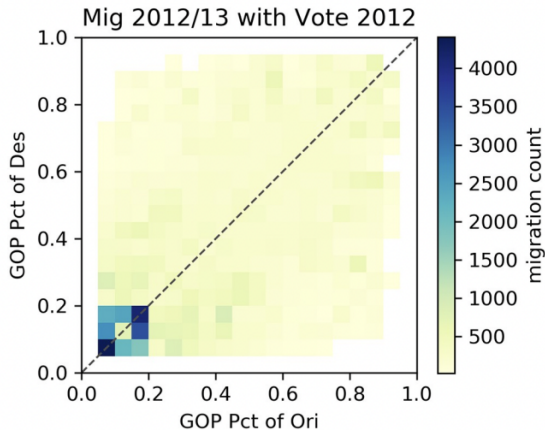
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2025

Motivation: high migration between locations that vote similarly

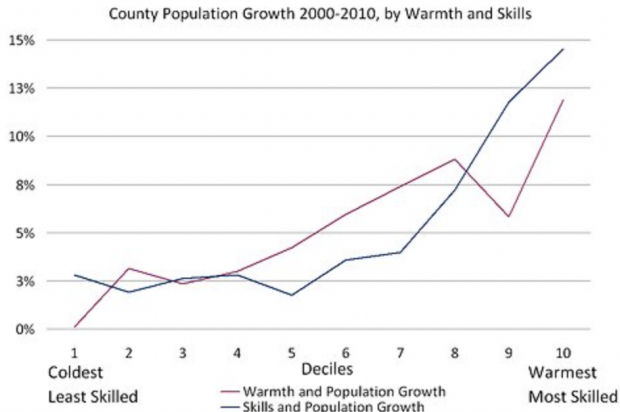
- Existing literature in political science / economic geography that finds migration between areas that are politically similar, e.g. Bishop (2009); Cho, Gimpel, Hui (2013); Liu, Andris, Desmarais (2019)



What are the spatial equilibrium consequences of this?

Motivation: distinguishing politics from other location characteristics

- ▶ Large literature in urban economics documenting different drivers of migration in recent decades: climate, college share, house prices, economic opportunity, amenities...
- ▶ For example, Glaeser (2011) on population growth vs. college share / Jan. temperature:

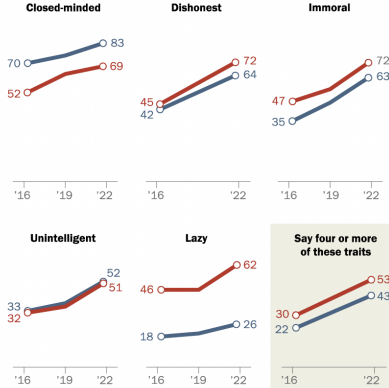


Is partisan sorting driven by other city characteristics or preferences for partisan alignment?
⇒ Need to know how migration differs by party affiliation!

Motivation: polarization has risen sharply over recent decades

% who say members of the **other** party are a lot/somewhat more ____ compared to other Americans

- Republicans say Democrats are more ...
- Democrats say Republicans are more ...



Note: Partisans do not include those who lean to each party.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted June 27-July 4, 2022.

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Has partisan sorting across geographies changed over time?

This paper

Research questions:

- ▶ *Do Democrats/Republicans prefer counties with co-partisan electorates?*
- ▶ *Do political differences between origin and destination raise migration costs?*
- ▶ *Have partisan preferences strengthened over 2012–2022?*
- ▶ *How do partisan preferences impact housing markets and regional population growth?*

1. **Data:** migration data with party affiliation from voter registration files
2. **Descriptive trends:** increasing migration to partisan-aligned locations
3. **Model:** spatial equilibrium location choice with political preferences $\Rightarrow$ empirical gravity model
4. **Empirical results:** increasing partisan preference gap between Ds and Rs since 2020 election, especially among Republicans
5. **Counterfactuals:** greater partisanship drives regional political segregation, lowers relative house prices in coastal states

Data

Migration by party affiliation (2012–2022):

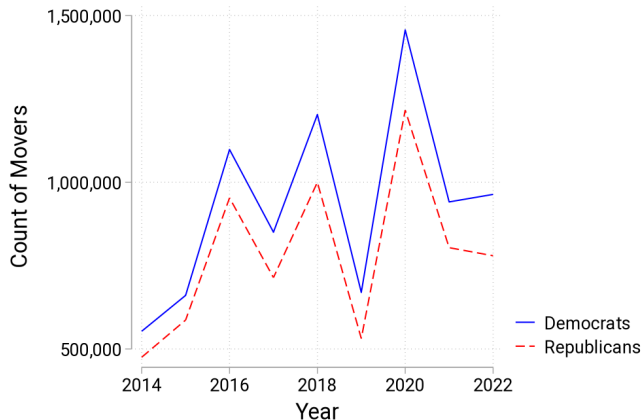
- ▶ Universe of registered voters (Statara): name, address history, DOB, party affiliation, linked across state lines
- ▶ We construct *Mover* variables by comparing individuals' linked voter registration information over time.
- ▶ Identify inter-county moves from address changes and build annual county-to-county *flows by party*
- ▶ Average flows over three periods aligned with election years: 2020–2022, 2016–2019, 2012–2015 (moves only for 2014–2015)

Location characteristics:

- ▶ Measure local partisanship using county Democratic vote share from presidential elections 2012/2016/2020 (MIT Election Data and Science Lab).
- ▶ Supplement with county avg. income (IRS), housing prices (Census + FHFA), amenities (County Business Patterns), climate, density, education, religion

Annual mover count by party

Annual number of individuals who move between counties based on voter registration files:



- ▶ Spikes in even years likely due to individuals re-registering to vote
- ▶ We aggregate migration across post-election periods, rather than using annual counts.

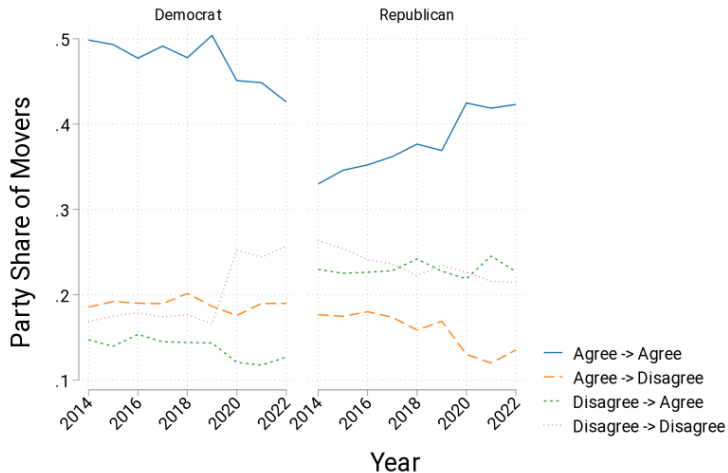
Average Statara Demographics by Party / Mover Status

	By Party			By Mover Status		
	Republican	Democrat	Diff.	Non-Mover	Mover	Diff.
Mover	0.064	0.055	0.009***			
Party Switcher	0.046	0.049	-0.003***	0.029	0.143	-0.114***
Age	52.003	50.675	1.328***	52.983	49.641	3.342***
Female	0.488	0.554	-0.066***	0.503	0.502	0.001
Non-Married	0.446	0.588	-0.142***	0.402	0.477	-0.075***
White	0.879	0.653	0.225***	0.629	0.754	-0.125***
Reg. Republican				0.139	0.140	-0.001
Reg. Democrat				0.184	0.157	0.027***
Reg. Other				0.448	0.460	-0.012***
Unregistered				0.229	0.243	-0.014***
Observations	297,517	413,302	710,819	1,449,745	98,280	1,548,025

* p< 0.10, ** p< 0.05, *** p< 0.01

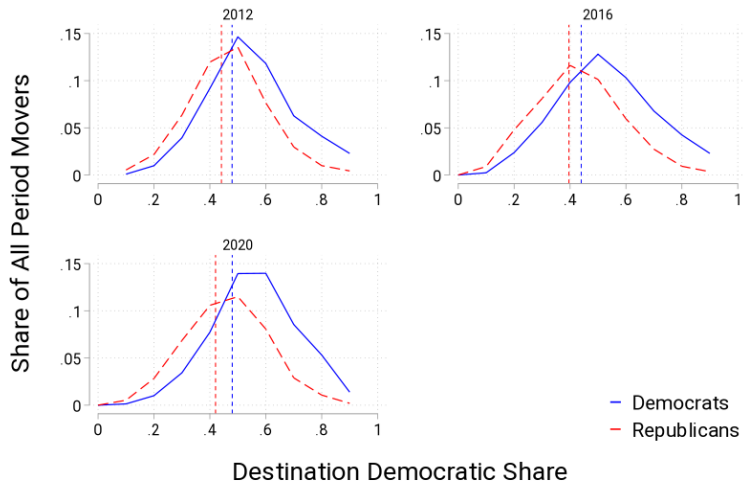
Movers increasingly do not cross “party lines”

Share of movers *within* each party moving within / across partisan areas, by origin / destination alignment:



Voting behavior at *D* vs. *R* destinations is diverging

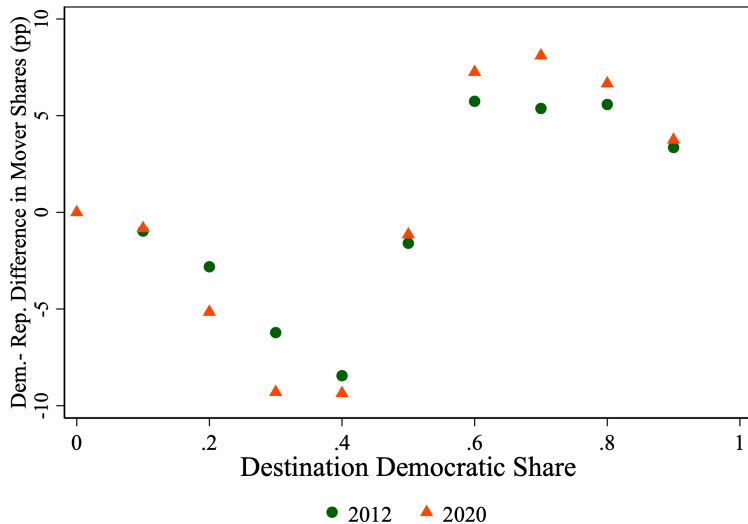
Distribution of movers from each party by the destination's Democratic share:



Democratic share gap (D vs. R movers) rises from **3.81 p.p. (2012 period)** to **6.0 p.p. (2020 period)**

Difference in the Party Share of Annual Movers

% of Dem. Movers - % of Rep. Movers in each bin:



Identifying the role of political alignment

Descriptive evidence

- ▶ Migration is partisan - destinations align with party preferences
- ▶ Migration has become more partisan over time

Identification issue:

- ▶ Other factors influence migration decisions, including prices, wages, and amenities
- ▶ If destination characteristics correlate with party alignment, moves may appear partisan—even without in-group preference

Methodology:

- ▶ Spatial equilibrium model to clarify channels
- ▶ Empirical approach to isolate causal effects of other factors

Model: Location Choice in Spatial Equilibrium

Setup. Workers of party $p \in \{D, R\}$ in origin i select destination j with utility:

$$U_{n,i \rightarrow j}^p = V_{i \rightarrow j}^p \cdot \varepsilon_{n,j}^p,$$
$$V_{i \rightarrow j}^p = \frac{B_j w_j}{P_j^\alpha} \exp(\delta^p \cdot \text{Alignment}_j^p - \tau_{i \rightarrow j})$$

- ▶ w_j : wages.
- ▶ P_j : housing cost
- ▶ $\varepsilon_{n,j}^p$: Fréchet-distributed location preference shock
- ▶ Alignment_j^p : political alignment with movers of party p (proxied by county vote in pres. election).
- ▶ $\tau_{i \rightarrow j}$: bilateral migration costs (distance, cultural/economic/political dissimilarity).

Gravity for flows $M_{i \rightarrow j}^p$:

$$\ln M_{i \rightarrow j}^p = \ln M_i^p + \theta \ln w_j + \theta \delta^p \cdot \text{Alignment}_j^p - \theta \tau_{i \rightarrow j} - \ln D_i^p$$
$$\ln M_{i \rightarrow j,t}^p = \underbrace{\alpha_{i,t}^p}_{\text{origin FE}} + \underbrace{\alpha_{j,t}^p}_{\text{dest FE}} + \underbrace{\gamma_{ij}}_{\text{pair FE}} + \varepsilon_{i \rightarrow j,t}^p.$$

Estimation Strategy for the importance of Partisan Alignment

Step 1: Estimate gravity by PPML with **high-dimensional FE** to recover:

- ▶ $\alpha_{j,t}^p$: destination attractiveness to party p in period t ,
- ▶ $\gamma_{ij,t}$: bilateral costs (time-varying).

Step 2: Allow $\gamma_{ij,t}$ to depend on bilateral characteristics (“barriers to moving somewhere *different*”):

$$\gamma_{ij,t} = \beta_0 + \beta_1 |DemShare_{i,t} - DemShare_{j,t}| + \alpha' |X_{i,t} - X_{j,t}| + \eta' |X_i - X_j| + \varepsilon_{ij,t}.$$

⇒ Estimated using original decomposition equation with $\alpha_{j,t}^p$ and $\alpha_{i,t}^p$ FEs to get SEs right

Step 3: Decompose destination attractiveness into common component and party-specific alignment (“preference for living somewhere *aligned*”):

$$\alpha_{j,t}^p = \psi_{jt} + \beta_1 \tilde{w}_{j,t} + \beta_2 DemShare_{j,t} + \xi^{p'} X_{j,t} + \varepsilon_{j,t}^p.$$

- ▶ Estimated using original decomposition equation with $\alpha_{j,t}$, $\alpha_{i,t}^p$ and γ_{ij} FEs to get SEs right

Result I: Political Dissimilarity Raises Bilateral Migration Costs

Decomposing bilateral resistance $\gamma_{ij,t}$ into bilateral characteristic differences:

$$\ln M_{i \rightarrow j,t}^P = \alpha_{i,t}^P + \alpha_{j,t}^P + \beta_1 |DemShare_{i,t} - DemShare_{j,t}| + \alpha' |X_{i,t} - X_{j,t}| + \varepsilon_{i \rightarrow j,t}^P.$$

Control variables (in differences):

- ▶ Ind. emp. distribution (2-dig. emp. share vector distance)
- ▶ Ethnic share distribution (vector distance)
- ▶ Distance
- ▶ Different state, state $\times$ distance
- ▶ Urban status
- ▶ College share in 2000
- ▶ Amenity indices (CBP business density)
- ▶ Water surface area %
- ▶ Density
- ▶ Church density
- ▶ Non-traditional Christian share (Saiz 2010)
- ▶ January temperature

Result I: Political Dissimilarity Raises Bilateral Migration Costs

$$\ln M_{i \rightarrow j, t}^P = \alpha_{i, t}^P + \alpha_{j, t}^P + \beta_1 |DemShare_{i, t} - DemShare_{j, t}| + \alpha' |X_{i, t} - X_{j, t}| + \varepsilon_{i \rightarrow j, t}^P.$$

	(1)	(2)	(3)
Dem. Vote Share Diff.	-0.714*** (0.118)	-0.697*** (0.138)	-0.908*** (0.143)
Dem. Vote Share Diff. × Period 2016-2019		-0.011 (0.057)	
Dem. Vote Share Diff. × Period 2020-2022		-0.031 (0.064)	
Dem. Vote Share Diff. × Republican Mover			0.431*** (0.095)
College Share Diff. (pp)	-0.003** (0.001)	-0.003** (0.001)	-0.003** (0.001)
Observations	5,477,776	5,477,776	5,477,776
Other characteristic diff.	Yes	Yes	Yes
Origin × Party × Period FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes
Destination × Party × Period FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes

* p < 0.10, ** p < 0.05, *** p < 0.01

- ▶ Larger county partisan gaps ⇒ **lower flows** (more negative γ): $\beta_1 < 0$
- ▶ **Magnitude:** 10 pp “political difference” $\approx$ 24 pp Δ in college share
- ▶ **Dynamics:** insignificant increase over time
- ▶ **Party differences:** Republican flows decline half as much as Dem. flows

Aversion to Political Difference is Not About Political Control

$$\ln M_{i \rightarrow j, t}^P = \alpha_{i, t}^P + \alpha_{j, t}^P + \beta_1 |DemShare_{i, t} - DemShare_{j, t}| \\ + \beta_1 |\mathbb{1}[DemMajority]_{i, t} - \mathbb{1}[DemMajority]_{j, t}| + \alpha' |X_{i, t} - X_{j, t}| + \varepsilon_{i \rightarrow j, t}^P.$$

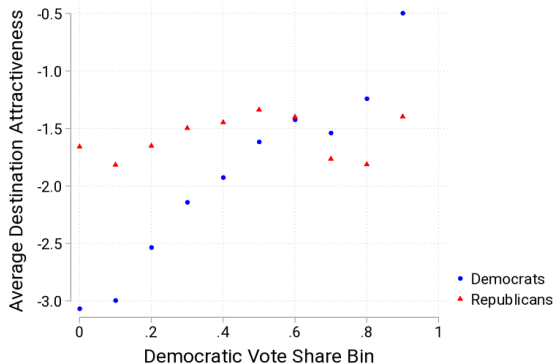
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Vote Majority Diff.	0.024 (0.024)	0.004 (0.026)	0.000 (0.028)
Dem. Vote Share Diff.	-0.780*** (0.152)	-0.713*** (0.175)	-0.910*** (0.189)
Vote Majority Diff.×Period 2016-2019		0.026 (0.023)	
Vote Majority Diff.×Period 2020-2022		0.020 (0.028)	
Vote Majority Diff.×Republican Mover			0.036* (0.019)
Dem. Vote Share Diff.×Period 2016-2019		-0.076 (0.093)	
Dem. Vote Share Diff.×Period 2020-2022		-0.084 (0.107)	
Dem. Vote Share Diff.×Republican Mover			0.317** (0.129)
Observations	5,477,776	5,477,776	5,477,776
Other characteristic diff.	Yes	Yes	Yes
Origin×Party×Period FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes
Destination×Party×Period FEs	Yes	Yes	Yes

* p< 0.10, ** p< 0.05, *** p< 0.01

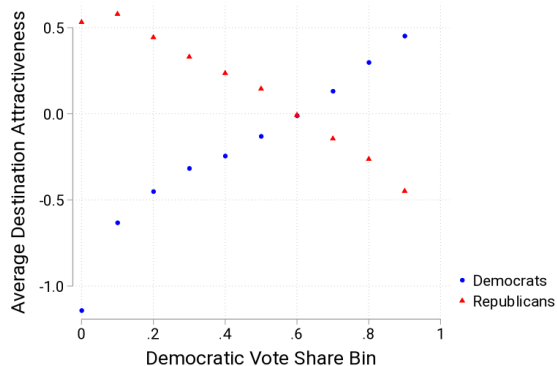
Difference in the Party Share of Annual Movers

Destination attractiveness $\alpha_{j,t}^P$ recovered from gravity model:

Raw estimates



Controls: house price, wages, amenities, destination FE



- ▶ Common preference for “Dem-voting places” highlights need to control for destination characteristics
- ▶ Opposing preference pattern w. controls suggests they eliminate “general attractiveness”
- ▶ Near-monotonic pattern suggests that results are not driven by extreme partisan counties

Result II: Partisan Alignment Drives Destination Attractiveness

$$\ln M_{i \rightarrow j,t}^p = \alpha_{i,t}^p + \gamma_{ij} + \beta_1 \text{Dem. Share}_{j,t} + \beta_2 \text{Dem. Share}_{j,t} \times \text{Republican}^p + \alpha' X_{j,t} + \varepsilon_{i \rightarrow j,t}^p.$$

	(1)	(2)	(3)
Dem. Vote Share	0.840*** (0.207)		
Dem. Vote Share $\times$ Republican	-3.066*** (0.070)	-3.070*** (0.069)	-3.300*** (0.087)
Observations	5,605,162	5,605,032	5,605,032
Time-var. dest. char. (ln W, ln P, Amen.)	X		
Origin $\times$ Party $\times$ Period FEs	X	X	X
Destination $\times$ Period FEs		X	X
Party $\times$ time-var. dest. char.			X

* p < 0.10, ** p < 0.05, *** p < 0.01

- ▶ Democrats: +10 pp democratic vote in destination $\Rightarrow$ +8% in-migration.
- ▶ Republicans: +10 pp democratic vote in destination $\Rightarrow$ -22% in-migration.
- ▶ Results survive destination-by-period FE and party-specific preferences for wages, prices & amenities.

Result III: Preference Gap b/w Parties Increased During Covid

$$\ln M_{i \rightarrow j, t}^P = \alpha_{i, t}^P + \gamma_{ij} + \beta_1 \text{DemShare}_{j, t} \times \sum \mathbb{1}\{\text{Period } t\} + \beta_2 \text{Dem. Share}_{j, t} \times \text{Republican}^P \times \sum \mathbb{1}\{\text{Period } t\} + \alpha' X_{j, t} + \varepsilon_{i \rightarrow j, t}^P$$

	(1)	(2)	(3)
Dem. Vote Share	0.957*** (0.162)		
Dem. Vote Share × Period 2016-2019	-0.077 (0.091)		
Dem. Vote Share × Period 2020-2022	-0.267** (0.109)		
Dem. Vote Share × Republican	-2.864*** (0.075)	-2.846*** (0.071)	-3.098*** (0.086)
Dem. Vote Share × Republican × Period 2016-2019	0.058 (0.065)	0.055 (0.037)	0.045 (0.040)
Dem. Vote Share × Republican × Period 2020-2022	-0.580*** (0.066)	-0.641*** (0.048)	-0.612*** (0.052)
Observations	5,605,162	5,605,032	5,605,032
Time-var. dest. char. (ln W, ln P, Amen.)	X		
Origin × Party × Period FEs	X	X	X
Destination × Period FEs		X	X
Party × time-var. dest. char.			X

* p < 0.10, ** p < 0.05, *** p < 0.01

- ▶ **Democratic movers:** effect of +10 pp DemShare on inflow declines from 9.6% (2014–15) → 6.9% (2020–22)
- ▶ **Republican movers:** effect of +10 pp DemShare on inflow declines from -19% (2014–15) → -28% (2020–22)
- ▶ **Robustness check:** Partisan gap increases by 20% during Covid

Partisan Preferences are Not About Political Control

$$\ln M_{i \rightarrow j, t}^P = \alpha_{i, t}^P + \gamma_{ij} + \beta_1 \text{DemShare}_{j, t} \times \sum \mathbb{1}\{\text{Period } t\} + \beta_2 \text{DemShare}_{j, t} \times \text{Republican}^P \times \sum \mathbb{1}\{\text{Period } t\} \\ + \beta_1 \text{DemMajority}_{j, t} \times \sum \mathbb{1}\{\text{Period } t\} + \beta_2 \text{DemMajority}_{j, t} \times \text{Republican}^P \times \sum \mathbb{1}\{\text{Period } t\} + \varepsilon_{i \rightarrow j, t}^P.$$

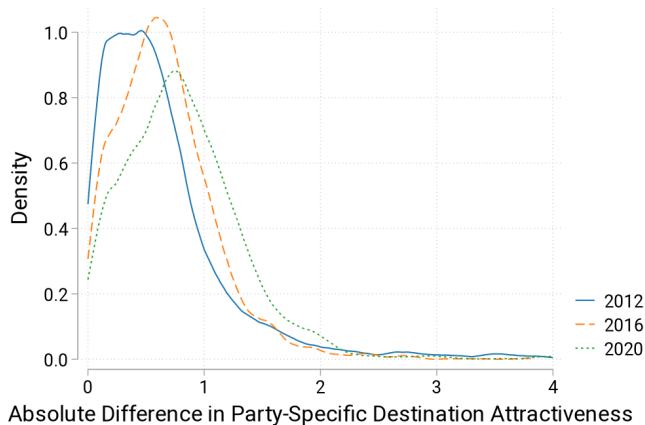
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Dem. Vote Share $\times$ Republican	-3.061*** (0.108)	-2.946*** (0.107)	
Dem. Majority $\times$ Republican	-0.003 (0.028)	0.037 (0.025)	
Dem. Majority $\times$ Republican $\times$ Period 2020-2022		-0.043 (0.046)	
Dem. Majority $\times$ Republican $\times$ Period 2016-2019		-0.048* (0.027)	
Dem. Vote Share $\times$ Republican $\times$ Period 2016-2019		0.184** (0.079)	
Dem. Vote Share $\times$ Republican $\times$ Period 2020-2022		-0.525*** (0.127)	
Observations	5,605,032	5,605,032	
Time-var. dest. char. (ln W, ln P, Amen.)	X		
Origin $\times$ Party $\times$ Period FEs	X	X	X
Destination $\times$ Period FEs		X	X
Party $\times$ time-var. dest. char.			X

* p < 0.10, ** p < 0.05, *** p < 0.01

No incremental effect of “winning” for either party in horserace against partisan population share

Implications: Geography is Becoming More Politically Segregated

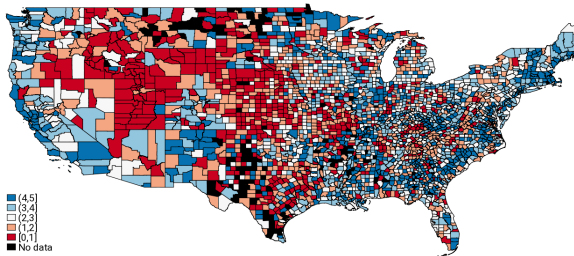
- ▶ Compute partisan attractiveness gap $d_{j,t} \equiv \alpha_{j,t}^D - \alpha_{j,t}^R$
- ▶ Distribution of $|d_{j,t}|$ shifts right: **fewer counties equally attractive to both parties**
- ▶ Stronger alignment preferences + higher bilateral costs for partisan gaps $\Rightarrow$ **segregation of movers by party.**



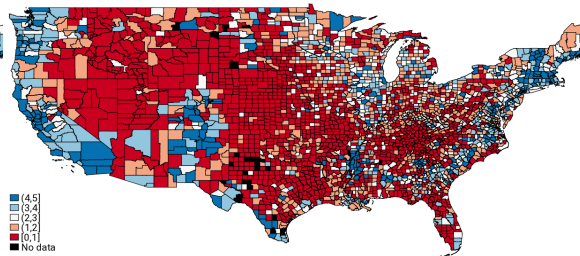
Implications: Stronger partisan regional preferences

- ▶ Partisan attractiveness gap over time: $d_{j,t} \equiv \alpha_{j,t}^D - \alpha_{j,t}^R$
- ▶ Quintiles based on fixed 2012 distribution of gaps

2014-15



2020-22



Counterfactuals

How do partisan preferences distort population growth and housing markets in different regions?

- ▶ Need a spatial equilibrium model to simulate GE effects on migration
- ▶ Allow for endogenous wages and house prices
- ▶ **Data issue:** partisan flows are unobserved for open-primary states $\Rightarrow$ matters for GE effects
- ▶ Can only estimate going from non-partisan to partisan scenario
- ▶ Lower bound for magnitude of effects as unobserved partisan flows are *larger* to partisan destinations, which see larger effect from change in partisanship.

Two scenarios:

- ▶ **“E pluribus unum”:** difference between no partisanship and 2014-15 levels from 2014-2015 population baseline (really: *ex uno plures*)
- ▶ **“Pandemic of partisanship”:** Difference between going to 2016-19 vs. 2020-22 levels of partisanship from 2016-2019 population baseline (*not today*)

Location choice and population dynamics

As before, **indirect utility** of a location j for party p mover from i is

$$v_{i \rightarrow j,t}^p = \ln w_{j,t} - \alpha \ln P_{j,t} + \delta_{p,t} \pi_{j,t}^p - \tau_{ij} + \psi_{j,t},$$

Choice probabilities and total flows are:

$$\mu_{j|i,t}^p = \frac{\exp(\theta v_{i \rightarrow j,t}^p)}{\sum_k \exp(\theta v_{i \rightarrow k,t}^p)}, \quad M_{i \rightarrow j,t}^p = L_{i,t}^p \mu_{j|i,t}^p,$$

so the **law of motion** for population (per period t) is

$$L_{j,t+1}^p = \sum_i L_{i,t}^p \mu_{j|i,t}^p.$$

where L_{ip} is the number of partisan party p voters in location i at the beginning of the period.

Housing markets and wages

Housing demand: With Cobb–Douglas expenditure, aggregate housing demand by $L_j = \sum_p L_{jp}$ residents is:

$$H_j^D = \alpha L_j w_j / P_j$$

Housing supply:

$$H_j^S = \bar{H}_j P_j^{\gamma_j}$$

- ▶ γ_j^S : county-specific supply elasticities
- ▶ $\bar{H}_j$: time-invariant local supply shifters

Market clearing $H_j^D = H_j^S$ pins down changes in P_j :

$$\Delta \ln P_{j,t} = \frac{1}{1 + \gamma_S} (\Delta \ln L_{j,t} + \Delta \ln w_{j,t})$$

Labor demand: allows for agglomeration forces ($\eta_j > 0$):

$$\ln w_{j,t} = \nu_{j,t}^w + \eta_j \ln \left(\frac{L_{j,t}}{\bar{L}_j} \right)$$

- ▶ $\nu_{j,t}^w$: time-varying productivity

Mapping the model to baseline data

Data:

- **Migration data:** use moves from aggregate IRS data $T_{i \rightarrow j, t}^{\text{IRS}}$, including “stayers”:

$$\mu_{j|i, t}^{\text{All}} \equiv \frac{T_{i \rightarrow j, t}^{\text{IRS}}}{\sum_k T_{i \rightarrow k, t}^{\text{IRS}}}.$$

- Baseline location **budget** term: $b_{j, t} \equiv \ln w_{j, t} - \alpha \ln P_{j, t}$,

Model inversion: Use IRS mover shares and observed budgets to invert out unobserved migration costs and amenities that explain mover shares:

$$K_{ij, t} \equiv \frac{1}{\theta} \left[\ln \mu_{i \rightarrow j, t}^{\text{All}} - \ln \mu_{i \rightarrow i, t}^{\text{All}} \right] - (b_{j, t} - b_{i, t}) = -\tau_{ij, t} + \psi_{j, t} - \psi_{i, t},$$

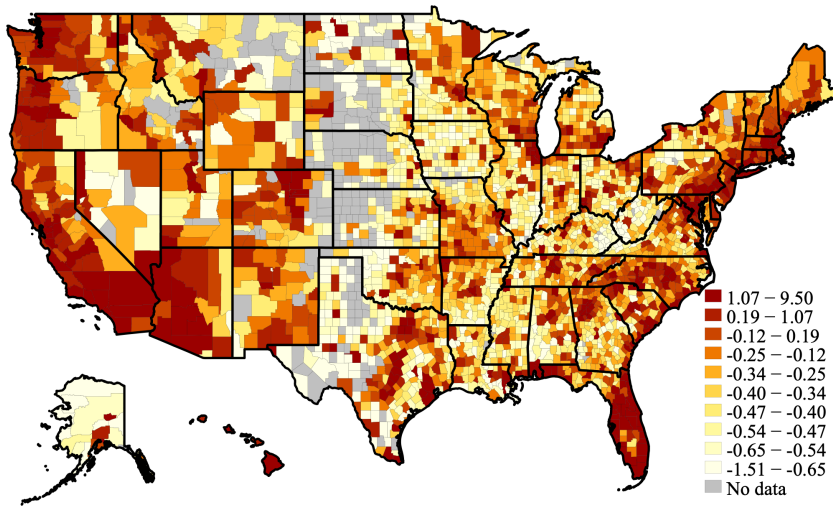
Residuals: to match baseline period-to-period IRS totals $L_{i, t}^{\text{tot}}$ exactly, define:

$$s_{j, t}^{\text{All}} \equiv L_{j, t+1}^{\text{tot}} - \sum_i L_{i, t}^{\text{tot}} \mu_{i \rightarrow j, t}^{\text{All}}.$$

- Hold $s_{j, t}^{\text{All}}$ fixed in counterfactuals to ensure $\sum_j L'_j = \sum_j L_{j, t+1}^{\text{tot}}$.

Destination amenities 2014-2015

Unobserved relative “attractiveness” $\psi_{j,t}$ inverted from 2014-2015 flows:



Counterfactual simulation: adding partisanship

Partisan flows . Let $p \in \{D, R, O\}$ denote Democrat, Republican, and Other/Non-partisans with $\delta_O = 0$. Allocate local population based on voting shares π_{it} and partisan shares σ :

$$\omega_{i,D} = \sigma \pi_{i,t}, \quad \omega_{i,R} = \sigma (1 - \pi_{i,t}), \quad \omega_{i,O} = 1 - \sigma, \quad \sum_p \omega_{i,p} = 1,$$

Fixed-point algorithm: Let $\hat{L}_j \equiv L'_j / L_{j,t+1}^{\text{tot}}$. Initialize $\hat{L}_j^{(0)} = 1$ for all j . Set new δ'_p .

1. Given $\hat{L}^{(m)}$, update wages, housing prices, and budget terms:

$$\ln \hat{w}_j = \eta_j \ln \hat{L}_j, \quad \ln \hat{P}_j = \frac{\ln \hat{L}_j + \ln \hat{w}_j}{1 + \gamma_j^S}, \quad b_j'^{(m)} = \ln w_j + \ln \hat{w}_j^{(m)} - \alpha(\ln P_j + \ln \hat{P}_j^{(m)}) \quad (1)$$

2. As $B'_{ij} = b'_j - b'_i$, update indirect utilities, location choices, and aggregate flows

$$v_{i \rightarrow j}^p = B'_{ij} + \delta'_p (\pi_{j,t} - \pi_{i,t}) + K_{ij,t}, \quad \mu_{j|i}^p = \frac{\exp(\theta v_{i \rightarrow j}^p)}{\sum_k \exp(\theta v_{i \rightarrow k}^p)} \quad \mu_{j|i}^{\text{All}'} = \sum_{p \in \{D, R, O\}} \omega_{i,p} \mu_{j|i}^p. \quad (2)$$

3. **New population totals** Update $L_j'^{(m)} = \sum_i L_{i,t}^{\text{tot}} \mu_{j|i}^{\text{All}'}{}^{(m)} + s_{j,t}^{\text{All}}$ and $\hat{L}_j^{(m)} = L_j'^{(m)} / L_{j,t+1}^{\text{tot}}$.
4. **Assess convergence** If $\max_j |\ln \hat{L}_j^{(m)} - \ln \hat{L}_j^{(m-1)}| < \varepsilon$, stop; else update to $\hat{L}^{(m)} \leftarrow (1 - \lambda) \hat{L}^{(m-1)} + \lambda \hat{L}^{(m)}$ and return to step 1.

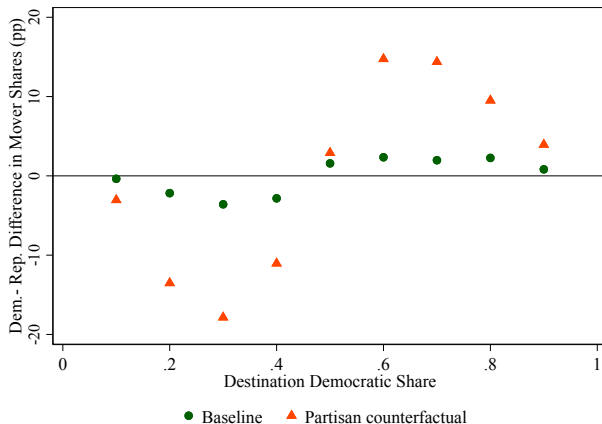
Model parameters

Description	Parameter	Source
<i>Political primitives</i>		
2014-15 partisan preferences	$\delta_D = 0.96, \delta_R = -1.90$	Gravity model estimates
2016-19 partisan preferences	$\delta_D = 0.88, \delta_R = -1.92$	Gravity model estimates
2020-22 partisan preferences	$\delta_D = 0.69, \delta_R = -2.75$	Gravity model estimates
Partisan population share	σ	Statara voter registration data 2014-2022
<i>Production and utility functions</i>		
Housing expenditure share	$\alpha = 0.62$	Moretti (2013), Diamond (2016)
County housing supply elasticities	γ_j^S	Baum-Snow & Han (2024), aggregated to counties
Agglomeration effect on wages	$\eta_j = 0.04$	Ahlfeldt and Pietrostefani (2019)
Fréchet dispersion parameter	$\theta = 3.3$	Monte, Redding, and Rossi-Hansberg (2018)
<i>Baseline populations</i>		
Baseline county population & migration flows	$L_{i,t}, \mu_{i \rightarrow j,t}$	IRS Migration data
Presidential election vote shares by party & county	$\pi_{j,t}$	MIT Election Data and Science Lab (2021)

Counterfactual: Partisan vs. Non-Partisan

Ex Uno Plura: *From 2014-15 with non-partisan preferences, add 2014-15 partisanship.*

% of Dem. Movers - % of Rep. Movers in each bin:

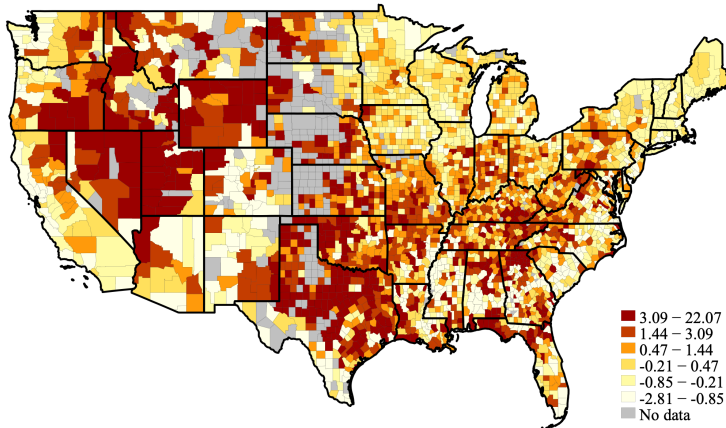


Partisanship leads Ds and Rs to segregate into high-D and high-R locations.

Counterfactual: Partisan vs. Non-Partisan

Ex Uno Plura: *From 2014-15 with non-partisan preferences, add 2014-15 partisanship.*

Population growth relative to baseline:

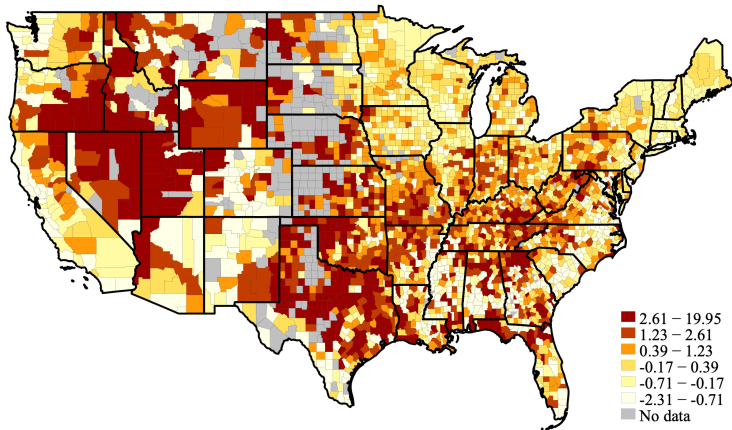


Strong Republican aversion to Democratic places increases *population* in Mountain states, reduces it on the coasts

Counterfactual: Partisan vs. Non-Partisan

Ex Uno Plura: *From 2014-15 with non-partisan preferences, add 2014-15 partisanship.*

House price growth relative to baseline:

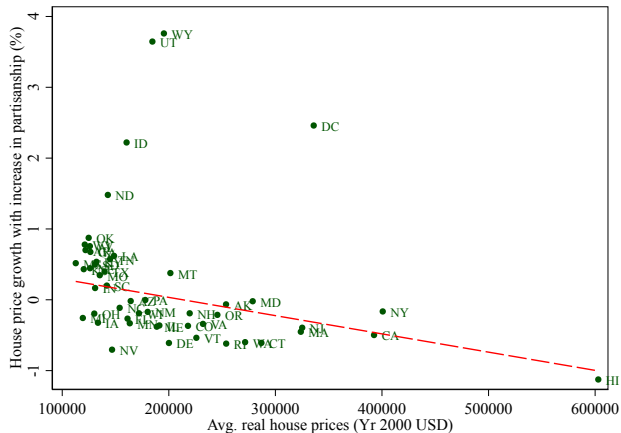


Strong Republican aversion to Democratic places increases *house prices* in Mountain states, reduces it on the coasts

Counterfactual: Partisan vs. Non-Partisan

Ex Uno Plura: *From 2014-15 with non-partisan preferences, add 2014-15 partisanship.*

House price growth relative to baseline house prices:



On average, partisanship equalizes house prices across states

Implications & next steps

- ▶ **Political alignment** has first-order importance in location choice
- ▶ **Changing partisanship:** Partisan gap in preferences for Dem.-voting location increased by **20%** since 2014–15, driven by large increase in Republican partisan preferences during Covid
- ▶ Counterfactuals show partisan preferences drive regional polarization and **decline of “purple” areas**
- ▶ Partisanship *equalizes* house prices across U.S. regions as it keeps Republicans out of cities with low housing supply elasticity

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Thank you for listening!

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Appendix

Average Statara Demographics

Characteristics of 2012 registered voters (1% sample):

	Mean	SD
Mover	0.063	0.244
Party Switcher	0.036	0.187
Age	50.040	18.586
Female	0.501	0.500
Non-Married	0.414	0.493
White	0.584	0.493
Reg. Republican	0.120	0.325
Reg. Democrat	0.166	0.372
Reg. Other	0.421	0.494
Unregistered	0.292	0.455
Observations	2,483,745	